

What to automate first worksheet

Compare 5 real tasks. Choose 1 safe first build. Put the rest in order.

Find 5 real candidates

List real work before choosing a tool. Select exactly 3 tasks to compare on Page 2.

BUSINESS AREA	DECISION OWNER	REVIEW PERIOD	RESULT WANTED THIS QUARTER

TASK AND USEFUL RESULT	REPETITION	TIME SPENT EACH MONTH	CURRENT OWNER	PROOF SOURCE	TAKE TO COMPARISON
					☐ Task 1
					☐ Task 2
					☐ Task 3
					☐ Task 4
					☐ Task 5

1. A task with no owner cannot be first.
2. A task with no evidence cannot be first.
3. A task that is hard to reverse cannot be first unless its safe first version removes that action.
4. Sensitive data without an approved rule for what data may be used moves to Prepare controls.
5. Customer-facing or lasting actions move to Prepare controls unless the first test is preparation-only.
6. Among the remaining tasks, put the task with the strongest proof, highest repetition, lowest failure cost and clearest recovery route first.

Compare the 3 finalists

Use the same evidence for every task. Do not add scores or arithmetic.

REPETITION: Many times daily / Daily / Weekly / Monthly or less	RISK: Read or prepare only / Reversible internal change / Customer-facing or lasting action	DATA: Public / Internal / Customer / Sensitive or regulated	OWNER: Owner and backup / Owner only / No owner
FAILURE COST: Small rework / Missed work or delay / Customer or money impact / Hard to recover	REVERSIBILITY: Undo in the same day / Restore manually / Hard or impossible to reverse	PROOF: Current record or example / Estimate only / No evidence	

Finalist 1 TASK REPETITION RISK OR HIGHEST ACTION DATA USED OWNER AND BACKUP FAILURE COST REVERSIBILITY OR RECOVERY ROUTE PROOF USED FOR THE COMPARISON EVIDENCE-BASED RANKING REASON DECISION / CHOOSE 1 ☐ Start first ☐ Prepare controls ☐ Keep manual ☐ Remove or merge	Finalist 2 TASK REPETITION RISK OR HIGHEST ACTION DATA USED OWNER AND BACKUP FAILURE COST REVERSIBILITY OR RECOVERY ROUTE PROOF USED FOR THE COMPARISON EVIDENCE-BASED RANKING REASON DECISION / CHOOSE 1 ☐ Start first ☐ Prepare controls ☐ Keep manual ☐ Remove or merge	Finalist 3 TASK REPETITION RISK OR HIGHEST ACTION DATA USED OWNER AND BACKUP FAILURE COST REVERSIBILITY OR RECOVERY ROUTE PROOF USED FOR THE COMPARISON EVIDENCE-BASED RANKING REASON DECISION / CHOOSE 1 ☐ Start first ☐ Prepare controls ☐ Keep manual ☐ Remove or merge
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What to automate first worksheet

Compare 5 real tasks. Choose 1 safe first build. Put the rest in order.

Put the work in order

Order the 3 tasks. Keep the evidence-based decision attached to each one.

1. Build first

ORDER

TASK

OWNER

WHY THIS POSITION

FIRST SAFE VERSION

PROOF TO COLLECT DURING THE TEST

HOW TO UNDO OR RESTORE THE CURRENT STATE

CONTROL STILL NEEDED

START DATE

REVIEW DATE

NEXT WORKSHEET / CHOOSE 1

☐ Simplify the tool stack

☐ Build lead follow-up

☐ Build a daily inbox brief

☐ Set limits for 1 AI job

☐ Monitor proven workflows

☐ Keep this task manual

2. Prepare next

ORDER

TASK

OWNER

WHY THIS POSITION

FIRST SAFE VERSION

PROOF TO COLLECT DURING THE TEST

HOW TO UNDO OR RESTORE THE CURRENT STATE

CONTROL STILL NEEDED

START DATE

REVIEW DATE

NEXT WORKSHEET / CHOOSE 1

☐ Simplify the tool stack

☐ Build lead follow-up

☐ Build a daily inbox brief

☐ Set limits for 1 AI job

☐ Monitor proven workflows

☐ Keep this task manual

3. Prepare after that

ORDER

TASK

OWNER

WHY THIS POSITION

FIRST SAFE VERSION

PROOF TO COLLECT DURING THE TEST

HOW TO UNDO OR RESTORE THE CURRENT STATE

CONTROL STILL NEEDED

START DATE

REVIEW DATE

NEXT WORKSHEET / CHOOSE 1

☐ Simplify the tool stack

☐ Build lead follow-up

☐ Build a daily inbox brief

☐ Set limits for 1 AI job

☐ Monitor proven workflows

☐ Keep this task manual

FINAL READINESS / EVERY CHECK MUST PASS

☐ The current process has been observed or documented.

☐ The ranking uses real proof.

☐ The owner and reviewer are named.

☐ The data source and rule for what it may use are approved.

☐ The first version prepares only or uses reversible test data.

☐ The expected result and proof are defined.

☐ The recovery route has been tested manually.

☐ The correct next worksheet is selected.

FINAL DECISION / CHOOSE 1

☐ Start safe test

☐ Collect proof

☐ Prepare control

☐ Keep manual

NEXT ACTION WITHIN 48 HOURS

PERSON AND DEADLINE